Indian thinking, including in several conversations between Premier Zhou Enlai and Indian Ambassador Panikkar. They engaged in careful study and research.

Based on these inputs they decided to deal with India in a piecemeal fashion rather than in a comprehensive way. When the facts showed that the boundary issue was complex, the Chinese decided to put it aside and to allow a temporary status quo to prevail; although, in their minds, India was in occupation of Chinese territory. In overall terms, their strategy resulted, in April 1954, in cancellation of all special privileges and rights that India enjoyed in Tibet, and securing, in a legally binding way, India's consent to China's occupation of Tibet by recognizing it as a 'Region' of China. In the end, all that was left of a complex problem in 1950 was an unresolved boundary issue, for which the Chinese had bought time and Indian goodwill until they were ready to deal with India from a position of strength.